

doors between classrooms to let neighbouring teachers bring their classes together and collaborate on topics that tie in with each other. Surfaces are provided both within classrooms (on desks) and in common spaces (glass tops over lockers) for students to write on using markers (for rough work), and then erase them once they are done. Digit had a chance to be a fly on the wall for a day at the school. Each student in middle and high school needs to compulsorily have a laptop. A Maths lesson (on simple and compound interest rate calculation), and the associated homework assignments, were driven by an online resource <http://www.mymaths.com/>. An English teacher was using online discussion boards to record the end-of-unit discussion on a poetry-based unit, wherein, students were to record their thoughts on the different types of poetry they read and wrote, and how they felt when they recited them to the class. The students would then receive peer and teacher feedback for their posts, and are also encouraged to submit their work to online competitions, such as the one at <http://poetryoutloud.org/>.

The school uses Veracross (<https://www.veracross.com/>), a web-based integrated student information and management system for student admissions, student attendance, student reporting, and preparing middle and high school course schedules. It also partners with “Haiku LMS” for its learning management system and “DyKnow” for teaching/learning features such as student-centric feedback (digital polling, problem solving, and student status) and shared whiteboards. It also utilizes “Edublogs Campus” the world’s largest provider of educational blogs, to allow its primary stakeholders (i.e., educators, students, and parents) to be active participants in the educational process through the web, and “Qualtricks” empowers its students to create, send and analyze innovative, web-based surveys.

Let us now try and explore how technology may enter an average classroom, even in a government school or an affordable private (low-fee) school.

Integrating technology: Continuing our vision

As Zeenat, the class teacher, steps into her classroom next morning, it is abuzz

Masterclass: Rocketship Education

The Rocketship Public School Model is at the forefront of leveraging technology to deliver high-quality education to large student audiences. A typical Rocketship classroom has about 100 students, where the content to be taught is decided by a lead teacher who also analyzes student data and sets daily goals for students. In the same physical classroom, the lead teacher is assisted by an associate teacher responsible for the direct instruction, and a “para” who manages personalization and tutoring.

Rocketship combines this “traditional classroom” approach with “Learning Lab” where individualized instruction is driven through online adaptive technology and tutors. The Rocketship Individualized Scheduling Engine (RISE) helps identify a student’s specific learning challenge early, by assessing the student’s mastery relative to predefined goals, quickly drill down to identify the underlying skills deficits which are preventing mastery, and review and coordinate the student’s progress in mastering basic skills in Learning Lab. It also facilitates communications between classroom teachers, Learning Lab staff and tutors, on the student’s progress.



General-Student-Side By a at Comp



Futurescope! A classroom with multiple interactive touch surfaces (courtesy: <http://tel.dur.ac.uk/synergynet/>)